

EPFL units: brochure vs. database

Why the database holds **442** units while the brochure reports **453 labs + 76 groups = 529**. Short version: the database is built from a professor list, so it only ever contains units that have a listed professor attached.

529 Brochure (453 labs + 76 groups)	442 Database (professor-derived)	496 Personnel export (any staff)	544 Union of both sources
---	--	--	-------------------------------------

The database is a by-product of a professor list, not a unit registry. The lab table is derived from the EPFL professor CSV: a unit only appears if at least one listed professor belongs to it. **102 units** have staff or students but no professor in that list, so they never enter the database. Add them back and the count (**544**) lands right on the brochure's **529**.

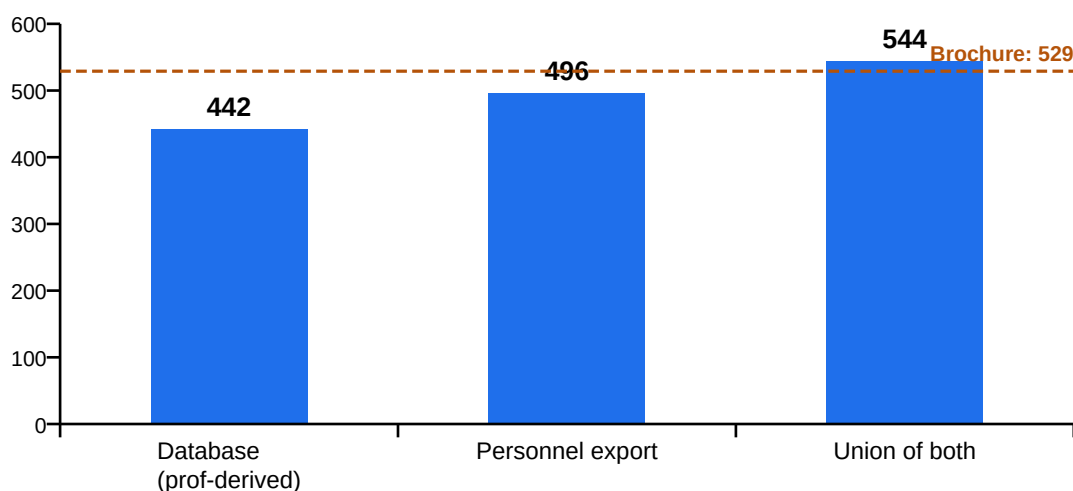
Root cause - professor-derived

Step 1 of the pipeline reads the professor CSV and builds the lab table as the **distinct units of those professors**. Units with no listed professor - led by senior scientists, technical staff, or a head already counted under their main unit - are invisible.

Taxonomy & snapshot mismatch

The two sources label units differently - the professor export uses LABO / GROUPE / CENTRE / SPC, the personnel export uses LABO / CENTRE / CHAIRE. The brochure's 2-way 'labs vs. groups' split maps cleanly to neither, and the two extracts are from different dates.

Distinct units by source



Sources: DB lab table (Feb 2026 professor list) · personnel export 'Donnees migrees' · matched on unit CF code / acronym. Dashed line = brochure total (453 labs + 76 groups).

Composition by unit type

Unit type	Database	Personnel export
LABO - lab	380	395
GROUPE - group	40	n/a
SPC - section	6	n/a
CENTRE - centre	16	56

CHAIRE - chair	n/a	45
Total	442	496

'n/a' = the type does not exist in that source's taxonomy. The same physical unit can be typed differently across systems (43 of 45 CHAIRE units appear as LABO/GROUPE in the professor list).

What differs between the two sources

102 units in personnel export, absent from DB 59 LABO, 41 CENTRE, 2 CHAIRE <i>Have staff/students but no listed professor - the main reason the DB under-counts.</i>	48 units in DB, absent from personnel export 35 GROUPE, 7 LABO, 4 SPC, 2 CENTRE <i>Mostly GROUPE/SPC types the personnel system doesn't use, plus a few closed/renamed units.</i>
---	--

Caveat: not all these units are distinct research labs. Many are administrative '... - Gestion' cost-centres or secondary units of a professor already counted (e.g. LMIS2 / LMIS4 / LO under Thiran). The number of genuinely professor-less research labs is smaller.

Units missing from the database (102)

Acronym	Unit name	Type	Recorded head
AICENTER-GE	AI Center - Gestion	CENTRE	FROSSARD PASCAL
AVP-E-CEDE	CEDE	CENTRE	JERMANN PATRICK
C4DT-GE	C4DT - Gestion	CENTRE	CROCHAT OLIVIER
CAM-GE	CAM - Gestion	CENTRE	PERRIARD YVES
CFFC-GE	CFFC- Gestion	CENTRE	MATTEINI FEDERICO
CHC-GE	CHC - Gestion	CENTRE	DUFAUX ALAIN
CIB-GE	CIB - Gestion	CENTRE	ABBE EMMANUEL
CIBM-GE	CIBM - Gestion	CENTRE	MARZILIANO PINA
CIBM-PCI	CIBM-Section Imagerie Pré-Clinique EPFL	CENTRE	CUDALBU MOLDOVAN CRISTINA RAMONA
CIBM-SP	CIBM - Section Signal Processing	CENTRE	UNSER MICHAEL
CIME-GE	CIME - Gestion	CENTRE	CANTONI MARCO
CMI-GE	CMI - Gestion	CENTRE	FLUECKIGER PHILIPPE
CMNT-GE	CMNT - Gestion	CENTRE	FONTCUBERTA I MORRAL ANNA
CPG-GE	CPG - Gestion	CENTRE	WAROT XAVIER
CWSC-GE	CWSC - Gestion	CENTRE	SCRIVENER KAREN
DCI-GE	DCI - Gestion	CENTRE	MYASNIKOV ALEXANDER
E4S	Enterprise for Society	CENTRE	AKLIN MICHAEL
ECOCLOUD-GE	EcoCloud - Gestion	CENTRE	ATIENZA ALONSO DAVID
EHUB	Pôle de formation à l'entrepreneuriat	CENTRE	BAVATO DAVIDE
EPFL-ECAL-GE	EPFL+ECAL Lab - Gestion	CENTRE	HENCHOZ NICOLAS
EPFLFR-BUILD	Building 2050 BUILD	CENTRE	AGUACIL MORENO SERGI
EPFLFR-CSLL	CSLL - Gestion	CENTRE	GONZENBACH MARTIN
ESC-SI	ESC-Space Innovation	CENTRE	KNEIB JEAN-PAUL
EXAF-GE	EXAF - Gestion	CENTRE	CHENAL JEROME
FURIES-GE	SCCER - Furies - Gestion	CENTRE	PAOLONE MARIO
HBP-PCO	HBP - Project Coordination Office	CENTRE	SUNDERLAND PAUL

Acronym	Unit name	Type	Recorded head
IMAGING-GE	IMAGING - Gestion	CENTRE	DONATI LAURENE
IRGC-GE	IRGC - Gestion	CENTRE	FLORIN MARIE-VALENTINE
MEDIA-GE	Centre Média - Gestion	CENTRE	KRICHANE MOUNIR
MHMC-GE	MHMC - Gestion	CENTRE	KLOK HARM-ANTON
PRN-ROBOT-GE	PRN-ROBOTICS - Gestion	CENTRE	FLOREANO DARIO
PRNMARVEL-GE	PRN-MARVEL - Gestion	CENTRE	MARZARI NICOLA
QSE-GE	QSE - Gestion	CENTRE	CAROFF PHILIPPE
RCP-GE	Research computing - gestion	CENTRE	MALLECK KHADIDJA
SCALA-GE	Scala - Gestion	CENTRE	JOVANOVIC DARJA
SCITAS	Inform. scientifique-support applicatif	CENTRE	CERIOTTI MICHELE
SCITAS-GE	SCITAS - Gestion	CENTRE	FOURESTEY GILLES
SNAI-GE	SNAI - Gestion	CENTRE	RAJMAN MARTIN
SPC-SG	SPC - Supraconductivité appliqué	CENTRE	FASOLI AMBROGIO
TRACE-GE	TRACE - Gestion	CENTRE	BIERLAIRE MICHEL
UPM-GE	UPM - Gestion	CENTRE	TRONO DIDIER
CMSO	Chaire Merck Serono en oncologie	CHAIRE	ORICCHIO ELISA
STAT	Chaire de statistique	CHAIRE	DAVISON ANTHONY
ACHT	Architecture,critique,histoire,théorie	LABO	VAN GERREWEY CHRISTOPHE
ADHER	Création architecturale et patrimoine	LABO	DEVAUX CLAUDIA
APRL	L. recherche particules atmosphériques	LABO	BINDER CLAUDIA R.
CNPA	Culture numérique projet architectural	LABO	BINDER CLAUDIA R.
EAST1	Archi. élémentaire&études typologiques 1	LABO	FROEHLICH MARTIN
EAST2	Archi. élémentaire&études typologiques 2	LABO	FROEHLICH ANJA
ECHO	Laboratoire d'écohydrologie	LABO	RINALDO ANDREA
ECOL	Laboratoire de technologie écologique	LABO	KOHN TAMAR
EMSI	Laboratoire de mécanique des interfaces	LABO	KOLINSKI JOHN MARTIN
GR-ANDERSON	Groupe Anderson	LABO	ANDERSON RICHARD
GR-CW	Groupe Wäckerlin	LABO	WAECKERLIN CHRISTIAN
GR-ET	Groupe Tolley	LABO	TOLLEY EMMA
GR-PAOLI	Groupe Paoli	LABO	PAOLI LUCAS
IBETON	Laboratoire de construction en béton	LABO	MUTTONI AURELIO
ICLAB	Laboratoire de circuits intégrés	LABO	THIRAN JEAN-PHILIPPE
LAMMM	L. modélisation mécanique multi-échelle	LABO	SHEA HERBERT
LASIG	L. systèmes d'information géographique	LABO	BINDER CLAUDIA R.
LBE	L. de biotechnologie environnementale	LABO	HOLLIGER CHRISTOF
LCA2	L. communications informatiques & appl.2	LABO	MAYOLY CAMILLE CHRISTINE MYRESE
LCAV	L. de communications audiovisuelles	LABO	VETTERLI MARTIN
LCP	Laboratoire de particules cosmiques	LABO	PERRINA CHIARA
LEAGO	L. étude électrophiles et fonct.génome	LABO	SIVULA KEVIN
LEAP	L. électromagn. et photonique avancés	LABO	ACHOURI KARIM
LESO-PB	L. énergie solaire & physique bâtiment	LABO	BINDER CLAUDIA R.
LIA	Laboratoire d'intelligence artificielle	LABO	FALTINGS BOI
LIDIAP	Laboratoire de l'IDIAP	LABO	CAVALLARO ANDREA
LMAM	L. mesure et analyse des mouvements	LABO	ROKE SYLVIE
LMIS2	Laboratoire de microsystèmes 2	LABO	THIRAN JEAN-PHILIPPE

Acronym	Unit name	Type	Recorded head
LMIS4	Laboratoire de microsystèmes 4	LABO	THIRAN JEAN-PHILIPPE
LMNN	L. neurobiol. molécul.& neuroprotéomique	LABO	LASHUEL HILAL
LMSC2	L. matériaux semiconducteurs (SB/STI)	LABO	FONTCUBERTA I MORRAL ANNA
LNB	Laboratoire de nanobiotechnologie	LABO	BOGHOSSIAN ARDEMIS ANOUSH
LO	Laboratoire d'optique	LABO	THIRAN JEAN-PHILIPPE
LPHE-LD	L. de physique des hautes énergies LD	LABO	DUFOUR LAURENT
LPMAT	Lab. mat. photoniques & caractérisation	LABO	HOFFMANN PATRIK WILLI
LSEN	L. de science à l'échelle nanométrique	LABO	KERN KLAUS
LSI1	Lab. des systèmes intégrés (IC/STI)	LABO	DE MICHELI GIOVANNI
LSI2	Lab. des systèmes intégrés (STI/IC)	LABO	DE MICHELI GIOVANNI
LSIR	L. de systèmes d'information répartis	LABO	MAYOLY CAMILLE CHRISTINE MYRESE
LTH2	Laboratoire de théorie et d'histoire 2	LABO	BINDER CLAUDIA R.
LTQE	Lab. pour traitement et qualité de l'eau	LABO	VON GUNTEN URS
MANSLAB-CO	Laboratoire de manufacture spatiale - CO	LABO	BLANC ALEXANDRE
MANSLAB1	Laboratoire de manufacture spatiale 1	LABO	BAKKER MARCO
MANSLAB2	Laboratoire de manufacture spatiale 2	LABO	BLANC ALEXANDRE
MCS	L. maintenance, const. & sécu. ouvrages	LABO	BINDER CLAUDIA R.
MCSS	math. computationnelles & science simul.	LABO	HESTHAVEN JAN S.
MIL	L. des mathématiques de l'information	LABO	SHKEL YANINA
MSIC-LAB	L. circuits intégrés signaux mixtes	LABO	SUBRAMANIAN VIVEK
PAL	Laboratoire d'adaptation des plantes	LABO	RAMAKRISHNA PRIYA
PL-LCH	P. de constructions hydrauliques	LABO	PERONA PAOLO
QMAT	L. des matériaux quantiques	LABO	KLOK HARM-ANTON
RPGL	L. de physique des roches et géofluides	LABO	KUSHNIR ALEXANDRA
TOPO	Laboratoire de topométrie	LABO	BINDER CLAUDIA R.
TOX	L. de toxicologie de l'environnement	LABO	SCHIRMER KRISTIN
TSAM	L. techniques & sauvegarde archi moderne	LABO	BINDER CLAUDIA R.
UPDUB	Unité du Prof. Duboule	LABO	DUBOULE DENIS
UPHCE	Unité de la Prof. Hering	LABO	BINDER CLAUDIA R.
VLSC	L. d'informatique à très grande échelle	LABO	MAYOLY CAMILLE CHRISTINE MYRESE
WR-LAB	L. de recherche sur les bassins versants	LABO	BINDER CLAUDIA R.

Units present in the personnel export but with no professor in the list used to build the DB. Head names shown as recorded (LASTNAME Firstname).